The Escapes

Game Design Document

1. title and pitch

the escapes is a small prison escape game where you find tools, watch guards and escape through a service door or ventilation shaft.

2. genre and platform

single-player stealth and escape puzzle game for android and ios, in landscape orientation. development uses unity

3. 2d or 3d

2d with a top-down view. the planned map is one prison block with a cell, corridor, canteen, storage room, office and yard. small rooms and clear paths keep the map readable on a phone.

4. core loop

explore -> collect -> unlock -> escape.

find a useful item, check the guard route and use the item to reach the next room. the target is a 5-10 minute escape attempt, to be adjusted after playtesting.

5. controls

bottom-left stick: move. bottom-right hand button: interact with a nearby item or door. top-right pause button: open the pause screen. three inventory slots will show carried items. keyboard movement and e are planned for testing.

main menu: play and quit. pause: resume, restart and menu. the hud shows three hearts and a score counter for collected objective items.

6. content and current scope

the full-game plan is one prison map, two escape routes and four item types: service pass, storage key, screwdriver and bandage. the pass opens the service exit. the key provides access to the screwdriver for the vent route. a bandage restores one heart, up to three.

assignment 8-9 covers project setup and three working ui screens: menu, hud and pause, tested on three device shapes. it does not include guards, item collection or a complete escape level. these systems belong to later weeks.

7. art and sound

top-down pixel art with pale floors, dark walls, orange prisoner clothes and blue guard details. planned sprite sources are kenney roguelike indoors and roguelike characters, both cc0. planned ui sounds are kenney interface sounds, also cc0. pixelify sans uses the sil open font license.

the escapists is a gameplay reference only. its artwork, maps, code and audio will not be reused. record source links and include the required licence notices when importing assets.

8. mvp for week 15

one playable prison, two escape routes, three guard behaviours, three-heart health, healing, inventory, saved progress, sound controls and win or lose feedback. guard behaviour details will follow assignment 10. finish and test one escape route before adding the second.

menu, hud, pause and mobile controls must fit a 16:9 phone, a notched phone and a 4:3 tablet. the a8-9 deliverable is the ui and project setup; the features above are the later build target.

9. cut list

no multiplayer, jobs, trading, npc relationships, full daily schedule, crafting tree, destructible walls, generated maps or long story campaign. no ads or purchases for assignment 8-9. publishing and monetisation are later decisions.

10. plan and roles

week 9: gdd, repository, menu, hud and pause. check safe area, anchors, text and touch targets in the device simulator on three screen shapes.

week 10: guard state machines, sight checks and attack warnings, following assignment 10.

week 11: map, item use, escape routes and saved progress.

week 12: footsteps, doors, alarm, music and volume controls.

week 13: visual feedback, device testing and fixes from playtests.

weeks 14-15: team formation under the course rules and final release preparation.

until week 14 this is a solo project. i am responsible for programming, level design, interface, asset selection, testing and the submission.